

Maschina

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Give software a job and money, safely, so it can go to work for you

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Abstract

The whole argument in one page. Software can now decide what to do with money. It cannot be trusted to hold it, because every system in use asks the software to enforce its own limits. Maschina puts the limits outside the software, where the software cannot reach them, and what emerges is a unit you can fund, instruct and leave alone.

The problem in one paragraph

Give an automated trader your money today and you are relying on it to restrain itself. Its limits live in its own configuration and are enforced by its own code. That arrangement holds until the first unexpected market, the first defect, the first stolen key. Then it fails completely, and it fails in the only way that matters, which is that the money is gone and does not come back.

This is not a small technical complaint. Roughly forty percent of crypto losses in recent years came from attackers obtaining keys rather than from any flaw in a protocol or a contract [2]. The weak point is custody, and custody is exactly what every agent framework hands to the agent.

What Maschina does about it

A machine on Maschina holds funds in a wallet created for it, whose policy is enforced by a key management provider that knows nothing about Maschina and permits exactly one destination: the owner. It spends against a budget held in a ledger it cannot edit. Its actions are checked by a rule engine that does not hold its signing key. It runs on nodes that hold no keys at all. Everything it decides, and why, is appended to a record that cannot be rewritten.

Three independent systems must agree before anything is signed, and any one of them can refuse alone. The third holds even if every server we operate is compromised.

What that makes possible

Once software can hold money safely, it can do work. Trading first, because it's the hardest test there is: real money, live markets, continuous operation, and an immediate cost to being slow.

Then the rest. Machines that hold positions and close them. Machines that pay for data, compute and each other's work. Machines that hire other machines with budgets tighter than their own. Machines published by the people who built them and copied by people who want them. All of it running on a network of computers owned by other people, who are paid for the work they do.

Why now

Payment standards for software agents arrived this year, carrying Visa, Stripe, Google, AWS, Coinbase and the Solana Foundation into a single foundation in April [8]. Solana now settles roughly half of all agent-protocol payment traffic [7]. The rails are being laid faster than the safety is.

The gap is the opportunity, and it is a gap in architecture rather than in intelligence.

What we will never do

We will not hold your money. We will not promise returns, publish numbers that did not happen, or show a projection dressed as an expectation. Most automated trading loses money over time and we say so in our own documents, because a business that needs its users to believe they are winning eventually needs them to be wrong about it.

Who is building it

Maschina Labs, founded by Asher Wilson. Built on Solana for throughput, cost, speed and the breadth of assets reachable from it. The complete system, with evidence, is in the whitepaper.